LAND OF ICE AND FIRE

Iceland lies on the volcanic seam of the mid-Atlantic ridge, where two tectonic plates are gradually growing and being forced apart. The land is dotted with active volcanoes, geysers, and glaciers.



AGRICULTURAL IMPACT

In Europe, ecological damage associated with human development is significant, with extensive urbanization, deforestation, and the conversion of land for agriculture.



FEATURED ECOREGIONS



- Norwegian Fjords ›› p134–39
 Coastal marine, alpine tundra
- Scottish Highlands ›› p140–45
 Temperate coniferous forest, moorland
- The Camargue ›› p146–51
 Wetland: river delta
- Tagus Valley ›› p152–57
 Mediterranean woodland, scrub
- The Alps ›› p158–63
 Temperate coniferous forest, alpine meadow
- Bavarian Forest ›› p164–73
 Temperate coniferous forest, broadleaf and mixed forest

WARMING CURRENT
A warm Atlantic current —an extension of the Gulf Stream— bathes the European coast, bringing a fairly stable climate, frequent rain, and mild temperatures to northern latitudes.

NORWEGIAN FJORDS
The landforms of the Norwegian coast, including flooded U-shaped valleys known as fjords, are among the most dramatic clues to northern Europe's glacial history.

MEDITERRANEAN SEA
Warm, salty, and almost landlocked, this sea has been adversely affected by fisheries and shipping, but still supports diverse underwater life.

ARCTIC OCEAN
Iceland
Norwegian Sea
Faroe Islands
Shetland Islands
Orkney Islands
Norwegian Fjords
Scandinavia
Gulf of Bothnia
Vänern
Gotland
British Isles
Grampian Mountains
North Sea
Jutland
Baltic Sea
North European
Elbe
Vistula
Severn
Thames
Rhine
English Channel
EUROPE
Ardennes
Seine
Brittany
Loire
Black Forest
Bavarian Forest
Carpathian Mo
Danube
Tisza
Lake Geneva
Alps
Massif Central
Mt Blanc △ 4,807m
Great Hungarian Plain
Drava
Bay of Biscay
Rhône
Po
Dinaric Alps
Cordillera Cantábrica
Pyrenees
Camargue
Apennines
Adriatic Sea
Douro
Ebro
Tagus
Iberian Peninsula
Corsica
Balearic Islands
Sardinia
Mediterranean Sea
Sierra Nevada
Ionian Sea
Sicily
Etna △ 3,263m
Peloponnese
Malta